LINTEL FIELD GUIDE · 02

Ten questions to ask *before you sign an interiors contract*

Most interiors go wrong in the gap between the people who draw and the people who build. These ten questions find that gap before you sign. **Ask every studio the same ten, and compare the answers side by side.**

01 Who is on your site on day 40?

Day one has the designer. Day 40 has whoever is actually building it. If those are two different companies, the gap between the drawing and the wall becomes **your** problem, and nobody owns it.

> **A good answer sounds like:** a named project executive on the studio's own payroll, on site daily, reporting to the same project manager as the designer.

02 Is the quote itemised, or is it a rate per square foot?

A per-sq-ft lump sum cannot be compared with another quote and cannot be checked against what arrives on site. Itemised means material, brand and hardware model per cabinet.

> **A good answer sounds like:** a line-by-line BOQ you can read, with brand names, not “premium hardware”.

03 What happens to the price if I change a finish after work starts?

Every project changes. The question is whether there is a written change process or an argument at the end.

> **A good answer sounds like:** a written change order with the price difference, approved by you before the change is made.

04 Who owns the gap between the drawing and the site?

Site walls are never square. Someone has to decide how the drawing adapts, and that decision should not cost you money.

> **A good answer sounds like:** the studio does, because the designer and the site team answer to one project manager.

05 What is the payment schedule tied to?

Payments tied to calendar dates pay for time. Payments tied to milestones pay for work.

> **A good answer sounds like:** milestones you can see: design sign-off, material delivery, carcass installation, handover.

06 What is warranted, for how long, and who comes when it fails?

A warranty is only as good as the phone number behind it. Ask for years per category and the response time.

> **A good answer sounds like:** written years for joinery, hardware and electrical, and a named support line with a response commitment.

07 How will I see progress and spend while work is on?

If the answer is “we will send photos on WhatsApp”, you will be chasing updates by week three.

> **A good answer sounds like:** a weekly update on a fixed day, and a system where your drawings, schedule and payments live in one place.

08 Which parts are factory-made and which are made on site?

Factory-cut panels are square, edge-banded by machine and repeatable. Site-made joinery depends on who turned up that day.

> **A good answer sounds like:** carcasses and shutters factory-made; only fitting and fixing on site, with a reason for any exception.

09 What is excluded?

Civil changes, electrical, plumbing, painting, false ceiling, appliances and loose furniture are the usual gaps. Each one is a surprise invoice later if it is not written down now.

> **A good answer sounds like:** an exclusions list on the quote, and a number for each item if you want it included.

10 Can I speak to a client you handed over to two years ago?

Anyone can show a handover-day photo. A kitchen that still works in year two is the real portfolio.

> **A good answer sounds like:** a yes, and a phone number the same day.

What we say at Lintel

One team, one contract, one number to call. The person who draws your home and the person who builds it report to the same project manager, and both run on Lintel OS, our in-house platform where your quote, drawings, schedule and payments live together. Bring this sheet to the experience centre and ask us all ten.

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